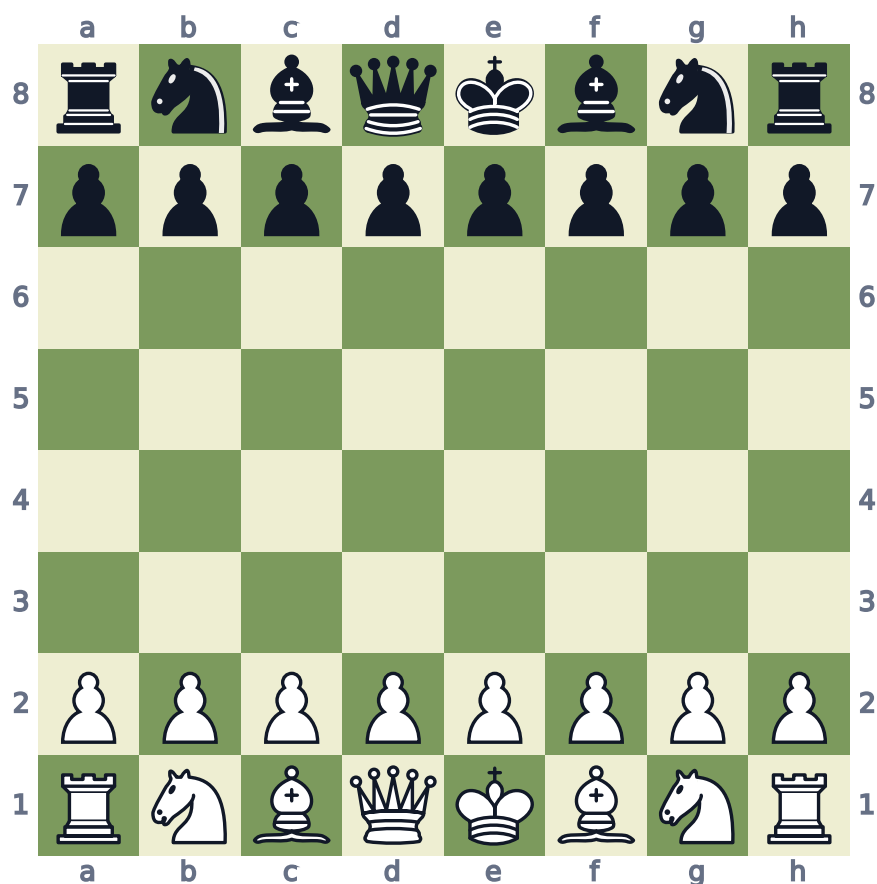


Chess Vocabulary and Notation Reference

An illustrated language guide for studying and analyzing chess



Make books, videos, Fritz analysis, and annotations easier to understand through a compact reference of tactical, strategic, opening, endgame, and notation terms.

140 practice units | separated solutions | scoring | review plan

ORIENTATION

How to get real improvement from this course

PURPOSE

Make books, videos, Fritz analysis, and annotations easier to understand through a compact reference of tactical, strategic, opening, endgame, and notation terms.

TRAINING RULES

- Use this as a reference while reading other PDFs or Fritz annotations.
- Say the definition in your own words and give a board example.
- Learn terms as mechanisms, not labels; a named weakness matters only when it can be exploited.
- Notation symbols and file formats are included so positions can move between phone, PDF, and Fritz.
-

COURSE SIZE

This PDF contains 140 practice units. Problems appear before their solutions whenever practical. Review misses after 1, 3, 7, 14, and 30 days.

INDEX

Alphabetical coverage

- A: 13 terms
- B: 5 terms
- C: 22 terms
- D: 14 terms
- E: 4 terms
- F: 7 terms
- G: 2 terms
- H: 2 terms
- I: 7 terms
- K: 4 terms
- L: 3 terms
- M: 3 terms
- O: 9 terms
- P: 16 terms
- R: 4 terms
- S: 6 terms
- T: 7 terms
- U: 6 terms
- V: 1 terms
- W: 2 terms
- X: 1 terms
- Z: 2 terms
-

REFERENCE

Terms 1-3

001. A BACKWARD PAWN IS WEAK ONLY IF IT CAN BE ATTACKED

Definition: Evaluate a backward pawn by accessibility, fixing power, and available breaks, not by shape alone.

Recognition cue: Pawn lacks neighbors; enemy controls its advance square; a file can be occupied by rooks.

002. A PAWN CENTER IS BOTH ASSET AND TARGET

Definition: Use a broad pawn center for space, but support it because the opponent will attack its base and advance points. Recognition cue: You occupy two central squares; the opponent uses hypermodern development; pawn breaks are approaching.

003. ACTIVATE THE KING

Definition: Use the king as a fighting piece once mating danger and queens are reduced. Recognition cue: Queens traded; few pieces remain; king can approach the center safely.

REFERENCE

Terms 4-6

004. ALGEBRAIC NOTATION

Definition: The standard system that names files a-h, ranks 1-8, pieces by letters, captures with x, check with +, and mate with #. Recognition cue: Core reference term

005. AN ISOLATED QUEEN PAWN IS DYNAMIC AND STATIC

Definition: Use the isolated d-pawn's space and open files actively before it becomes a fixed endgame weakness. Recognition cue: An isolated d-pawn; active pieces; possible d4-d5 break; approaching simplification.

006. ANALYZE BEFORE USING AN ENGINE

Definition: Record your thoughts, candidates, and evaluations before consulting computer analysis. Recognition cue: Post-game review; a surprising move; you do not understand where the position changed.

REFERENCE

Terms 7-9

007. ASK WHAT CHANGED

Definition: After every move, identify newly opened lines, newly weak squares, changed defenders, and altered tactical possibilities. Recognition cue: Every move, especially pawn moves, captures, checks, castling, and moves by a key defender.

008. ASK WHAT THE OPPONENT WANTS

Definition: Before executing your own plan, identify the opponent's best improvement and consider preventing it cheaply. Recognition cue: Quiet position; opponent has a clear break or piece route; one useful move can hinder it.

009. ATTACK A PAWN CHAIN AT ITS BASE

Definition: Undermine the least mobile supporting pawn rather than pushing only against the chain's advanced point. Recognition cue: A locked center; diagonal pawn chain; one base pawn cannot be advanced safely.

REFERENCE

Terms 10-12

010. ATTACK WHERE YOUR PAWN CHAIN POINTS

Definition: Use the space and lines on the side toward which your central pawns advance. Recognition cue: Closed center; opposing chains point to different wings; both sides need a plan.

011. AVOID EARLY QUEEN ADVENTURES

Definition: Do not expose the queen to repeated attacks unless it wins something concrete. Recognition cue: A pawn can be grabbed; the queen would enter enemy territory; several opposing pieces can develop by attacking it.

012. AVOID UNNECESSARY PAWN WEAKNESSES

Definition: Do not create isolated, backward, or weak-color squares unless you receive activity, space, or another concrete benefit. Recognition cue: A pawn move is only prophylactic; an exchange changes the skeleton; the opponent can fix and attack a target.

REFERENCE

Terms 13-15

013. AVOID WEAKENING A COLOR COMPLEX

Definition: Do not move or exchange the pawns and pieces controlling one color around your king without checking enemy access. Recognition cue: Fianchetto bishop may be exchanged; king pawns move onto one color; enemy queen and bishop form a battery.

014. BACKWARD PAWN

Definition: A pawn unable to advance safely and lacking support from adjacent pawns. Recognition cue: Core reference term

015. BATTERY

Definition: Two or more long-range pieces aligned on the same file, rank, or diagonal. Recognition cue: Core reference term

REFERENCE

Terms 16-18

016. BISHOPS NEED OPEN DIAGONALS

Definition: Use pawn breaks, exchanges, or rerouting to give bishops meaningful scope. Recognition cue: Bishop blocked by its own center; long diagonal can open; opposing pawns sit on its color.

017. BLOCKADE A PASSED PAWN

Definition: Place a suitable piece directly in front of an enemy passed pawn to stop it and attack around it. Recognition cue: An enemy passer reaches the fifth or sixth rank; direct capture is impossible; a knight or king can occupy the blockading square.

018. BRING MORE PIECES THAN THE DEFENDER

Definition: Build local superiority around the target before sacrificing or opening lines. Recognition cue: Enemy king has limited defenders; pieces can transfer with tempo; lines can be opened.

REFERENCE

Terms 19-21

019. CALCULATE FORCING LINES FIRST

Definition: Analyze moves that sharply restrict replies before branching into quiet alternatives. Recognition cue: King exposure; hanging material; mating nets; tactical races; contact captures.

020. CALCULATE PAWN RACES EXACTLY

Definition: Count moves to promotion, checks, captures, and king entry rather than relying on visual intuition. Recognition cue: Passed pawns on both wings; kings cannot stop everything; exchanges lead to a race.

021. CANDIDATE MOVE

Definition: A serious move selected for calculation before the final choice is made. Recognition cue: Core reference term

REFERENCE

Terms 22-24

022. CASTLE BEFORE LAUNCHING AN ATTACK

Definition: Secure the king and activate a rook before investing tempi in offensive operations. Recognition cue: The center may open; queens remain; you are considering pawn pushes or repeated attacking moves.

023. CENTER

Definition: Usually the squares d4, e4, d5, and e5, plus the surrounding central region. Recognition cue: Core reference term

024. CENTRALIZE BEFORE STARTING A PAWN RACE

Definition: Improve the king and pieces before committing pawns to a race when no immediate breakthrough is required. Recognition cue: Both wings have pawns; no forced promotion; kings are distant from the center.

REFERENCE

Terms 25-27

025. CHOOSE ROOK ACTIVITY OVER PAWN GRABBING

Definition: Prefer checks, king restriction, and penetration when taking a pawn would make the rook passive.

Recognition cue: Enemy pawn is available; rook can invade the seventh rank or cut off the king; king safety matters.

026. CLASSIFY MISTAKES BY CAUSE

Definition: Tag errors as calculation, evaluation, knowledge, time management, emotional, or process failures.

Recognition cue: Post-game review; repeated losses; the engine shows several unrelated bad moves.

027. CLEARANCE

Definition: Vacating a square or line so another piece can use it. Recognition cue: Core reference term

REFERENCE

Terms 28-30

028. COMPARE MOVES, DO NOT DEFEND YOUR FIRST IDEA

Definition: Try to disprove each candidate and compare resulting positions instead of collecting reasons to like the first move. Recognition cue: You feel emotionally attached to a move; a sacrifice looks exciting; two candidates have different risks.

029. CONNECT THE ROOKS

Definition: Complete development so no pieces remain between the rooks and the queen can coordinate or move safely. Recognition cue: Both minor pieces are developed; king has castled; queen can choose a useful square.

030. CONNECTED PASSERS

Definition: Adjacent passed pawns that can protect one another. Recognition cue: Core reference term

REFERENCE

Terms 31-33

031. CONTROL THE CENTER

Definition: Influence the central squares with pawns and pieces so your army has room and the opponent has fewer active routes. Recognition cue: The first moves; an opponent neglects the center; you are deciding between flank and central development.

032. CONVERT SPACE INTO PIECE IMPROVEMENT

Definition: Use extra territory to place pieces on better squares rather than pushing more pawns automatically. Recognition cue: You control more ranks; opponent is cramped; no immediate breakthrough exists.

033. COORDINATE THE QUEEN WITH MINOR PIECES

Definition: Use the queen to amplify piece pressure rather than operating alone. Recognition cue: Bishop points toward king; knight controls flight squares; queen can join without being chased.

REFERENCE

Terms 34-36

034. COUNT ATTACKERS AND DEFENDERS

Definition: Before initiating exchanges on a contested square, count attackers, defenders, and the order in which they can participate. Recognition cue: A central pawn break; a sacrifice on the king; several pieces converge on one square; a long exchange sequence.

035. COUNTER A FLANK ATTACK IN THE CENTER

Definition: When the opponent spends time on a wing, seek a timely central break. Recognition cue: Several wing pawn pushes; the center remains unstable; the opponent's king is not fully secure.

036. CREATE A DISTANT PASSED PAWN BEFORE CASHING IT IN

Definition: Use the threat of promotion to gain king activity or win pawns rather than pushing automatically. Recognition cue: Defender is tied to the passer; your king can enter elsewhere; the pawn need not advance yet.

REFERENCE

Terms 37-39

037. CREATE A FLIGHT SQUARE

Definition: Give the king an escape square when back-rank or mating-net danger is concrete. Recognition cue: King boxed by pawns; enemy rook or queen controls entry line; back-rank tactics are possible.

038. CREATE A PASSED PAWN FROM A MAJORITY

Definition: Use a local pawn majority to exchange opposing pawns and leave one passer. Recognition cue: Three pawns face two; kings are active; pawn exchanges can be forced.

039. CREATE A SECOND WEAKNESS

Definition: When one target is fully defended, open play on the opposite wing or create another permanent problem. Recognition cue: Opponent is tied to one pawn; direct breakthrough fails; you have space to switch wings.

REFERENCE

Terms 40-42

040. CREATE AN OUTSIDE PASSED PAWN

Definition: Create a passer far from the main pawn mass to divert the enemy king. Recognition cue: Pawn majorities on opposite wings; kings can reach only one side quickly; exchanges can create a remote passer.

041. DECOY

Definition: Forcing a piece onto a square where it becomes tactically vulnerable. Recognition cue: Core reference term

042. DEFEND ACTIVELY WITH COUNTER-THREATS

Definition: Prefer defensive moves that improve pieces, attack the opponent, or create escape options. Recognition cue: Several defensive moves work; one can attack queen, king, or central base; your pieces are passive.

REFERENCE

Terms 43-45

043. DEFLECTION

Definition: Forcing a defender away from a duty. Recognition cue: Core reference term

044. DEMAND CONCRETE COMPENSATION FOR A SACRIFICE

Definition: Sacrifice material only for calculable gains such as mate, perpetual check, material recovery, lasting king exposure, or dominating activity. Recognition cue: Forced lines; trapped king; development lead; several pieces can join quickly.

045. DEVELOP MINOR PIECES EFFICIENTLY

Definition: Bring knights and bishops into useful play before making repeated moves with one piece. Recognition cue: Early opening; several pieces remain on the back rank; the opponent has spent time on pawns or queen moves.

REFERENCE

Terms 46-48

046. DEVELOPMENT

Definition: Bringing pieces from their starting squares into useful activity. Recognition cue: Core reference term

047. DISCOVERED ATTACK

Definition: Moving one piece reveals an attack from a sliding piece behind it. Recognition cue: Core reference term

048. DO NOT CLOSE THE CENTER WITHOUT A PLAN

Definition: Before advancing a pawn to lock the center, identify which wing and which pawn break will create play. Recognition cue: A pawn advance would create interlocking chains; kings may attack on opposite wings; central tension can be maintained.

REFERENCE

Terms 49-51

049. DO NOT HUNT PAWNS WHILE BEHIND IN DEVELOPMENT

Definition: Treat extra pawns as secondary when collecting them costs multiple tempi and leaves pieces inactive. Recognition cue: A side pawn is available; the queen or one piece must move repeatedly; the center can open.

050. DO NOT RUSH PAWN MOVES

Definition: Preserve pawn tempi and structure until the move creates a concrete gain. Recognition cue: Few pieces; symmetrical pawns; zugzwang or opposition may arise.

051. DO NOT TRADE YOUR BEST PIECE WITHOUT COMPENSATION

Definition: Preserve the piece that creates your activity unless the exchange wins material, structure, safety, or a favorable ending. Recognition cue: Your best piece is offered a trade; simplification looks convenient; one piece controls critical squares.

REFERENCE

Terms 52-54

052. DOUBLE CHECK

Definition: A move gives check from two pieces simultaneously; only a king move can answer it. Recognition cue: Core reference term

053. DOUBLE ROOKS BEFORE INVADING

Definition: Add a second rook when one rook cannot safely penetrate or win the file alone. Recognition cue: Both sides contest one file; entry square is guarded; queen can help connect rooks.

054. DOUBLED PAWNS CAN GIVE USEFUL LINES

Definition: Weigh doubled pawns against the files, central control, and bishop pair gained in the exchange. Recognition cue: A bishop captures a knight; a recapture doubles pawns; an open file appears.

REFERENCE

Terms 55-57

055. ECO CODE

Definition: A classification code that groups chess openings from A00 through E99. Recognition cue: Core reference term

056. EVALUATE THE RESULTING POSITION

Definition: Judge a move by the position it produces, not by how active or attractive the move looks. Recognition cue: A combination ends; queens may be traded; a pawn break changes structure; a move wins material but loses activity.

057. EXCHANGE THE OPPONENT'S MOST ACTIVE PIECE

Definition: When under positional pressure, seek a favorable trade of the enemy piece doing the most work. Recognition cue: One knight dominates an outpost; a bishop controls both wings; a rook occupies the seventh rank.

REFERENCE

Terms 58-60

058. EXCHANGE THE STRONGEST DEFENDER

Definition: Identify and remove the piece controlling entry squares, flight squares, or key blocks around the king.

Recognition cue: Fianchetto bishop guards dark squares; knight covers mating square; queen holds the back rank.

059. FEN

Definition: Forsyth-Edwards Notation: a one-line description of a single position, including side to move, castling rights, and en passant status. Recognition cue: Core reference term

060. FIANCHETTO

Definition: Developing a bishop to b2, g2, b7, or g7 after moving the adjacent knight pawn. Recognition cue: Core reference term

REFERENCE

Terms 61-63

061. FIND OVERLOADED DEFENDERS

Definition: Look for a defender assigned to two jobs that cannot both survive a forcing sequence. Recognition cue: One piece guards mate and material; a queen protects two pieces; a rook defends the back rank and a pawn.

062. FIX A WEAKNESS BEFORE ATTACKING IT

Definition: Prevent a target from advancing, exchanging, or escaping before piling up pressure. Recognition cue: Weak pawn can advance; target can be exchanged; a controlling pawn move can restrain it.

063. FORCING MOVE

Definition: A check, capture, or direct threat that sharply restricts the opponent's replies. Recognition cue: Core reference term

REFERENCE

Terms 64-66

064. FORK

Definition: One unit attacks two or more targets at once. Recognition cue: Core reference term

065. FORTRESS

Definition: A defensive setup that cannot be broken despite a material disadvantage. Recognition cue: Core reference term

066. GENERATE MULTIPLE CANDIDATE MOVES

Definition: Create a short candidate list before calculating deeply. Recognition cue: More than one plausible plan; a critical position; tactical tension; a choice between improving and forcing moves.

REFERENCE

Terms 67-69

067. GOOD AND BAD BISHOPS DEPEND ON PAWN PLACEMENT

Definition: Judge a bishop by whether its own pawns obstruct it and whether it can attack useful targets.

Recognition cue: Locked pawn chains; bishop appears outside the chain; endgame with fixed pawns.

068. HALF-OPEN FILE

Definition: A file with no friendly pawn but at least one enemy pawn. Recognition cue: Core reference term

069. HANGING PAWNS

Definition: Side-by-side isolated pawns, usually on c- and d-files, that provide space and dynamic breaks but may become targets. Recognition cue: Core reference term

REFERENCE

Terms 70-72

070. IDENTIFY THE OPPONENT'S THREAT

Definition: Treat the opponent's last move as information: ask what it attacks, enables, prevents, and abandons.

Recognition cue: The opponent makes a quiet move; a piece enters your half; a pawn approaches your king; a defender moves away.

071. IDENTIFY THE REAL THREAT

Definition: Name the opponent's concrete threat and its required conditions before choosing a defense.

Recognition cue: Opponent moves near your king; sacrifice seems possible; several defensive moves tempt you.

072. IMPROVE THE WORST-PLACED PIECE

Definition: When no tactic or urgent threat exists, improve the piece contributing least. Recognition cue: A quiet position; one undeveloped piece; a rook without a file; a knight on the rim; a bishop blocked by its pawns.

REFERENCE

Terms 73-75

073. INITIATIVE

Definition: The ability to create threats that make the opponent respond. Recognition cue: Core reference term

074. INTERFERENCE

Definition: Blocking the line between a sliding defender and its target. Recognition cue: Core reference term

075. IQP

Definition: Isolated queen's pawn, usually an isolated d-pawn that grants activity but can become an endgame weakness. Recognition cue: Core reference term

REFERENCE

Terms 76-78

076. ISOLATED PAWN

Definition: A pawn with no friendly pawn on either adjacent file. Recognition cue: Core reference term

077. KEEP QUEENS WHEN THE KING IS THE MAIN TARGET

Definition: Avoid queen exchanges when your principal advantage is an attack and the enemy king remains vulnerable. Recognition cue: Enemy king exposed; your queen is active; opponent offers a queen trade.

078. KING PAWN MOVES CREATE LASTING HOLES

Definition: Advance pawns around your king only for a concrete defensive or attacking purpose. Recognition cue: Creating luft; chasing a piece; starting a pawn storm; stopping a pin or check.

REFERENCE

Terms 79-81

079. KNIGHTS NEED STABLE OUTPOSTS

Definition: Route knights toward protected central squares that enemy pawns cannot attack. Recognition cue: Closed center; pawn-created hole; protected square on the fifth or sixth rank.

080. KNIGHTS OFTEN DEVELOP BEFORE BISHOPS

Definition: Develop knights early when their natural squares are clear, while delaying bishops until the pawn structure reveals their best diagonals. Recognition cue: Openings with natural knight squares; uncertainty about whether a bishop belongs on c4, b5, e2, or g2.

081. LAUNCH A PAWN STORM ONLY WITH CENTRAL SECURITY

Definition: Advance wing pawns when the center is closed, your king is elsewhere, or central counterplay is controlled. Recognition cue: Opposite-side castling; locked center; pieces support the pawn advance.

REFERENCE

Terms 82-84

082. LEARN OPENING PLANS MORE THAN MOVES

Definition: Memorize the purpose, pawn breaks, piece placements, and typical tactical risks behind an opening line. Recognition cue: The opponent deviates early; you forget theory; several moves seem plausible.

083. LUCENA POSITION

Definition: A fundamental winning rook ending where the stronger side builds a bridge against checks. Recognition cue: Core reference term

084. MAINTAIN USEFUL TENSION

Definition: Delay a capture or pawn advance when releasing tension would improve the opponent more than you. Recognition cue: Two pawns or pieces attack each other; neither capture is forced; the opponent has an awkward defensive burden.

REFERENCE

Terms 85-87

085. MEET A WING ATTACK IN THE CENTER

Definition: Seek central counterplay when the opponent has committed time and pawns to one flank.

Recognition cue: Pawn storm; unstable central pawns; your pieces can support a break.

086. MINORITY ATTACK

Definition: Advancing fewer pawns against a larger pawn group to create a structural target. Recognition cue:

Core reference term

087. OPEN FILE

Definition: A file containing no pawns, often useful for rook activity. Recognition cue: Core reference term

REFERENCE

Terms 88-90

088. OPEN LINES TOWARD THE KING

Definition: Use pawn breaks, exchanges, or sacrifices to create files and diagonals leading to the enemy king.

Recognition cue: Pieces point at the king but pawns block access; a lever can force a capture; king shelter has a fixed pawn.

089. OPEN LINES WHEN YOUR PIECES ARE BETTER

Definition: Transform superior activity into concrete access by opening files and diagonals. Recognition cue:

Your rooks and bishops are aligned; opponent's pieces are passive; a pawn exchange can open a line.

090. OPEN THE CENTER WHEN BETTER DEVELOPED

Definition: Use pawn breaks or exchanges to expose lines when more of your pieces are ready. Recognition

cue: You lead by two or more developed pieces; the enemy king is central; a central break is available.

REFERENCE

Terms 91-93

091. OPPOSITE-SIDE CASTLING MAKES TIME CRITICAL

Definition: When kings castle on opposite wings, prioritize direct pawn storms and forcing play over slow material gains. Recognition cue: Kings on different wings; centers closed or stable; rook pawns can advance with tempo.

092. OPPOSITION

Definition: A king-ending relationship in which the side not required to move often controls entry squares. Recognition cue: Core reference term

093. OUTPOST

Definition: A protected square, commonly for a knight, that enemy pawns cannot challenge. Recognition cue: Core reference term

REFERENCE

Terms 94-96

094. OVERLOAD

Definition: A piece has more defensive duties than it can perform in one move. Recognition cue: Core reference term

095. OVERPROTECT A CRITICAL SQUARE

Definition: Defend a strategically important square with more pieces than immediately necessary when it anchors your position or future activity. Recognition cue: Central outpost; key pawn break square; one square supports several plans.

096. PASSED PAWN

Definition: A pawn with no enemy pawn ahead on its file or neighboring files. Recognition cue: Core reference term

REFERENCE

Terms 97-99

097. PASSED PAWNS MUST BE ADVANCED WITH SUPPORT

Definition: Use a passed pawn to gain space and distract pieces, but coordinate its advance with the rest of the army. Recognition cue: No enemy pawn can stop it; pieces can escort it; the opponent is tied to blockade.

098. PAWN BREAK

Definition: A pawn advance intended to create contact and transform the structure. Recognition cue: Core reference term

099. PAWN ISLAND

Definition: A connected group of friendly pawns separated from another group by empty files. Recognition cue: Core reference term

REFERENCE

Terms 100-102

100. PAWNS CANNOT MOVE BACKWARD

Definition: Treat every pawn move as a permanent change to squares, lines, and future structure. Recognition cue: Any optional pawn move; a pawn push near your king; an attempt to chase a piece.

101. PERFORM A BLUNDER CHECK

Definition: Before committing a move, scan the destination and resulting position for checks, captures, and one-move threats by the opponent. Recognition cue: Every move, especially when moving a defender, pushing a pawn, or feeling excited about an attack.

102. PERPETUAL CHECK

Definition: A repeating series of checks that forces a draw. Recognition cue: Core reference term

REFERENCE

Terms 103-105

103. PGN

Definition: Portable Game Notation: a text format for complete games, metadata, moves, comments, and variations. Recognition cue: Core reference term

104. PHILIDOR POSITION

Definition: A fundamental rook-ending defensive setup using rank control and checks from behind. Recognition cue: Core reference term

105. PIN

Definition: A piece is restricted because moving it would expose a more valuable piece or the king. Recognition cue: Core reference term

REFERENCE

Terms 106-108

106. PLACE ROOKS ON OPEN FILES

Definition: Use rooks on files without friendly pawns to penetrate or pressure targets. Recognition cue: Central pawn exchange; isolated pawn; one file leads to the seventh rank or a weak pawn.

107. PREFER REVERSIBLE MOVES BEFORE IRREVERSIBLE ONES

Definition: When choices are equally useful, delay commitments that permanently change pawns, exchanges, or king position. Recognition cue: Several decent developing moves; an unclear pawn break; uncertainty about which wing will be attacked.

108. PREPARE PAWN BREAKS

Definition: Before pushing a structural break, place pieces where opened lines and resulting squares favor you. Recognition cue: A standard break is available; center is locked; rooks and bishops can align behind the intended exchange.

REFERENCE

Terms 109-111

109. PRESERVE MOVE-ORDER FLEXIBILITY

Definition: Choose early moves that keep several sound structures available until the opponent reveals commitments. Recognition cue: Several development moves transpose; the opponent has not committed a central pawn; castling side is unclear.

110. PROPHYLAXIS

Definition: Anticipating and restricting the opponent's intended plan or tactical resource. Recognition cue: Core reference term

111. PUT THE ROOK BEHIND A PASSED PAWN

Definition: Place a rook behind a passed pawn, whether it is yours or the opponent's, when the file is accessible. Recognition cue: Open file behind a passer; rook ending; pawn can advance with support.

REFERENCE

Terms 112-114

112. REMOVE THE DEFENDER

Definition: When a target is adequately protected, calculate whether its key defender can be exchanged, deflected, pinned, or distracted. Recognition cue: A mating square has one guard; a passed pawn is blockaded by one piece; a tactical target is defended exactly once.

113. REROUTE A MISPLACED PIECE

Definition: Spend time correcting a piece with no useful future rather than pretending it will become relevant. Recognition cue: Piece has few legal squares; attacks no target; blocks a rook or pawn; another stable route exists.

114. RESPECT BACK-RANK GEOMETRY

Definition: Check whether a king without flight squares is vulnerable to rook or queen penetration. Recognition cue: Castled king; unmoved rook pawns; open file; enemy rook or queen can reach the back rank.

REFERENCE

Terms 115-117

115. RETURN MATERIAL TO NEUTRALIZE THE INITIATIVE

Definition: Give back extra material when it completes development, trades attackers, or removes king danger.

Recognition cue: You are materially ahead but undeveloped; king is exposed; opponent has strong piece activity.

116. SCAN CHECKS, CAPTURES, AND THREATS

Definition: At every move, scan forcing candidates for both sides before examining quieter moves.

Recognition cue: Any tactical position; king exposure; hanging pieces; a move that attacks queen or king; lines that just opened.

117. SEARCH FOR ZWISCHENZUGS

Definition: Before making an expected recapture, look for an in-between check, attack, or stronger capture.

Recognition cue: Both sides have hanging pieces; a recapture appears automatic; a check is available; a queen can be attacked with tempo.

REFERENCE

Terms 118-120

118. SIMPLIFY PRESSURE INTO A DEFENSIBLE ENDING

Definition: Offer exchanges when the resulting endgame removes attack and remains structurally viable.

Recognition cue: Under sustained attack; queen trade available; endgame material and pawn structure can be evaluated.

119. SKEWER

Definition: A valuable front piece is attacked and must move, exposing a target behind it. Recognition cue: Core reference term

120. SPEND TIME AT CRITICAL MOMENTS

Definition: Use more clock time when the position changes irreversibly or several serious candidates exist.

Recognition cue: Structure changes; tactics begin; queens may trade; move chooses a long-term plan.

REFERENCE

Terms 121-123

121. STOP AT QUIET POSITIONS AND EVALUATE

Definition: End a calculation branch only when forcing moves have subsided, then evaluate the stable position.

Recognition cue: A combination involves exchanges; a check sequence ends; material changes; queens leave the board.

122. TACTICS COME BEFORE STRATEGY

Definition: Before choosing a strategic plan, verify that no forcing tactic changes the position immediately.

Recognition cue: An exposed king; loose pieces; contact between opposing pieces; a recent pawn move that opened a line.

123. TEMPO

Definition: One move of time; gaining a tempo makes progress while forcing a reply. Recognition cue: Core reference term

REFERENCE

Terms 124-126

124. THE BISHOP PAIR PREFERS OPEN POSITIONS

Definition: Preserve two bishops when the center is likely to open and targets exist on both colors. Recognition cue: Few central pawns; play on both wings; opponent has bishop and knight or two knights.

125. TRACK LOOSE PIECES

Definition: Continuously note pieces that are undefended or defended only once. Recognition cue: Multiple pieces share a defender; queens oppose rooks; pieces sit on the same rank, file, or diagonal.

126. TRADE ATTACKING PIECES

Definition: Exchange the enemy units most responsible for threats, especially queens or key minor pieces. Recognition cue: Opponent has several pieces near your king; a favorable trade is available; endgame is defensible.

REFERENCE

Terms 127-129

127. TRADE PIECES WHEN CRAMPED

Definition: Exchange pieces, especially active enemy pieces, to reduce congestion in a space disadvantage.

Recognition cue: Your pieces obstruct each other; no useful breaks; opponent has more territory but no immediate attack.

128. TRADE PIECES, NOT PAWNS, WHEN AHEAD

Definition: When materially ahead, exchange active pieces while preserving enough pawns to win. Recognition

cue: Extra piece or exchange; safe king; favorable simplification is available.

129. UNDERPROMOTION

Definition: Promoting a pawn to a rook, bishop, or knight instead of a queen for a tactical reason. Recognition

cue: Core reference term

REFERENCE

Terms 130-132

130. USE DEFLECTION AND DECOY

Definition: Force an enemy piece away from a duty or onto a vulnerable square. Recognition cue: A defender is tied to a square; a king can be drawn onto a line; a queen guards a mating point.

131. USE OUTPOSTS BEHIND FIXED PAWNS

Definition: Place a piece on a square that enemy pawns can no longer challenge. Recognition cue: Pawns are fixed; an enemy pawn has advanced past a square; a knight can reach the hole.

132. USE PRINCIPLES TO NARROW AND CALCULATION TO DECIDE

Definition: Let principles produce candidates, then let concrete analysis select the move. Recognition cue: Any non-forced decision; conflicting plans; a position that resembles a familiar pattern but has one changed detail.

REFERENCE

Terms 133-135

133. USE THE OPPOSITION

Definition: In king-and-pawn endings, arrange kings so the opponent must yield the critical entry square.

Recognition cue: Bare kings and pawns; direct, distant, or diagonal opposition; a key square decides promotion.

134. USE THREATS TO GAIN TEMPI

Definition: Choose improving moves that also create a real threat the opponent must answer. Recognition cue:

Piece can develop with attack; pawn break gains tempo; queen or rook can enter with a concrete threat.

135. VERIFY THE BEST DEFENSE

Definition: Judge a combination against the opponent's strongest resource, not the reply you hope to see.

Recognition cue: You think you found a win; a sacrifice begins the line; the opponent has several legal replies.

REFERENCE

Terms 136-138

136. WEAK PAWN

Definition: A pawn that can be attacked more easily than it can be defended or advanced. Recognition cue: Core reference term

137. WEAK SQUARE

Definition: A square that cannot be defended adequately by a pawn and can be occupied or attacked.
Recognition cue: Core reference term

138. X-RAY

Definition: Latent pressure through an intervening piece along a rank, file, or diagonal. Recognition cue: Core reference term

REFERENCE

Terms 139-140

139. ZUGZWANG

Definition: A position where every legal move worsens the mover's situation. Recognition cue: Core reference term

140. ZWISCHENZUG

Definition: An in-between move played before an expected recapture or routine reply. Recognition cue: Core reference term

REVIEW

Vocabulary retrieval

1

Choose ten terms and explain each without using the term itself.

2

Draw or set up one board example for five tactical terms.

3

Use five strategic terms in the analysis of one slow game.

4

Import one FEN and one PGN into Fritz to verify that you understand the formats.

RETRIEVAL SCHEDULE

Repeat missed positions tomorrow, then after 3, 7, 14, and 30 days. Remove a position only after two correct solutions with a complete explanation.